

Constitution of the First-Generation Student Alliance

Last Update:

Article I: Name of the Organization and Affiliation

Section I. The formal name of this organization shall be the First-Generation Student Alliance (FGSA).

Section II. FGSA is affiliated with First-Gen at Furman, which oversees Furman University's initiatives for first-generation students.

Article II: Purpose

The First-Generation Student Alliance (FGSA) is an inclusive, community-building organization dedicated to providing welcoming spaces for first-generation students on campus at Furman University. Furman University defines first-generation students as those for whom neither parent nor guardian has earned a bachelor's degree or higher.

The group aims to foster fellowship, increase access to campus support services, and amplify the voice of first-generation students through student programming and engagement.

Article III: Membership

Section I. In accordance with Furman University's non-discrimination policies, membership is open to all undergraduate and graduate students. Our organization is committed to a policy of non-discrimination consistent with Furman's Non-Harassment and Non-Discrimination Policy.

Section II. All active members are eligible to be included in FGSA communications, participate in First-Gen student initiatives on campus, and receive merchandise.

- a. Active membership is defined as students of Furman University who participate in FGSA programming, vote during Executive Board elections, attend general body meetings, and are willing to contribute to program preparation.
- b. All graduating senior members of FGSA will receive cords provided by First-Gen at Furman.

Section III. FGSA implements a point system. Points are accrued by fulfilling the actions laid out in the definition of active membership under *Article III, Section 2*.

- a. FGSA activities will be allocated points as follows:
 - i. Helping organize FGSA sponsored events will equal 3 points

- ii. Engagement in a FGSA sponsored event will equal 2 points
 - iii. Attendance at events promoted by FGSA will equal 1 point
 - iv. Voting during Executive Board elections will equal 1 point
 - v. Attending general body meetings will equal 1 point
- b. The point system will be used to allocate rewards throughout the academic year.
- c. The points are accrued throughout the duration of a student's membership in FGSA.
- d. All active members of FGSA who have accumulated at least 20 points by graduation will receive a senior gift at the FGSA yearly banquet.

Article V: The Executive Board

The Executive Board of FGSA, comprising a President, Vice President, Treasurer, and Secretary, shall be responsible for developing strategies to promote club growth, convening biweekly for event planning purposes, maintaining active communication with the FGSA advisor and First-Gen at Furman leadership, and resolving internal conflicts within the organization. Qualified members who can run for Executive Office are those who have been actively involved in the organization during the prior academic semester. The process by which executive board positions are determined is left to the discretion of the existing executive board each spring of the academic year. In the event that a position becomes vacant, a popular vote of the membership will fill this vacancy until the following spring term. Executive board positions read as follows:

Section I: President. Under the supervision of the FGSA advisor, the President serves as the representative of the First Generation Student Alliance and is responsible for approving club initiatives, attending club meetings, leading both executive board and general body meetings, facilitating an inclusive and altruistic space in compliance with Furman University policies, overseeing collaborative initiatives with other organizations, and working alongside other executive board members to ensure club growth. The President or designee is responsible for oversight of the FGSA point system. The President must be present on campus for the duration of their leadership commitment (i.e., one academic year, Spring through Fall semester). In the event of an Executive Board vacancy, the President will consult with the FGSA advisor to determine who will be responsible for the duties of that role until the vacancy is filled.

Section I: Vice President. The Vice President of FGSA works in collaboration with the President. The Vice President will lead meetings in place of the President when necessary, assist with decision-making within the executive board, and work directly alongside the president. The responsibilities of revising the FGSA constitution, facilitating T-shirt sales in the Fall, and delivering a speech at the annual First-Gen at Furman welcome luncheon are assigned to the Vice President, overseeing campaigning for FGSA.

Section III: Treasurer. The treasurer of FGSA is responsible for submitting budget requests, overseeing FGSA transactions and expenditures, managing the SDC credit card,

and acting as the liaison between the First-Gen Student Alliance and SDC. As the liaison between FGSA and SDC, the treasurer must also adhere to the SDC financial bylaws.

Section IV: Secretary. The Secretary is responsible for updating resources provided through SyncDin, maintaining a record of the points acquired by all members of FGSA, and managing a roster of membership (differentiating between members and active members).

Article VI: Elections

Elections for executive officers will be held at the end of every spring (the specific date of yearly elections will be left to the discretion of the existing executive board), in which active members of FGSA who are First Gen shall run for any of the executive positions listed in *Article V*. A majority vote of membership will appoint active members to executive positions each year. Additionally, executive board members shall receive the power of removing pre-existing members of the council through a majority vote if there is due cause for removal.

Article VII: Advisor

The FGSA advisor shall provide guidance and mentorship to officers as well as facilitate escalated internal conflicts within FGSA as needed. FGSA's advisors complete all necessary university paperwork required by SDC and the Office of Student Involvement.

Article VIII: Meetings and Events

FGSA shall hold monthly general body meetings and additional events throughout the academic year, which are determined by the executive board. Any additional meetings/events must also be arranged by the existing executive board and be finalized two weeks before execution. Lastly, the final meeting of the spring term will include elections.

Article IX: Finance

FGSA is primarily funded by the Student Diversity Council (SDC). Additional funds may be provided by the university as it relates to university FGSA initiatives.

Article X Amendments

In the instance that amendments are proposed by member(s) of the executive board, a 1/2 vote of the executive board and membership is required for approval.